

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 3
 ♥ A K J 4
 ♦ Q J T 4
 ♣ K T 5 3

♠ T 4

♥ Q 8 6

♦ A 9 6 3

♣ J 6 4 2



♠ A 6

♥ T 7 5 3 2

♦ K 8 7

♣ A Q 9

♠ K Q J 9 8 7 5 2

♥ 9

♦ 5 2

♣ 8 7

West

North

East

South

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South
 partner for the ♥Q they can make slam.

This is what preempting is all about.

You dealt this hand.

With 7 estimated winners and an 8-card suit you preempt 4♠. And you are not going to make it. In fact you are only going to make 8 tricks so you will go down 2.

You may be wishing that you had opened just 3♠, rather than following the guidelines and opening at the 4-level. The problem with that thinking is that the lower your preempt, the less difficult it is for the opponent's to enter the bidding. If you had opened 3♠ West might have been able to make a Takeout Double and they could have found their ♥ fit. Just visualize their combined hands; they have 9 ♥s between them, they have no ♠ losers, no ♣ losers and just one ♦ loser. If they decide to finesse your

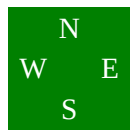
Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 5
♥ J 9 4 3
♦ T 7 6
♣ Q T 9 5

♠ T 6
♥ A K Q 8 5
♦ A K
♣ A 8 6 4



♠ 4 2
♥ T 7 2
♦ Q J 5 3
♣ K J 3 2

♠ K Q J 9 8 7 3
♥ 6
♦ 9 8 4 2
♣ 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

It is hard to imagine any hand partner could have where the slam wouldn't be there. Maybe you should use Blackwood, just to be sure? If partner shows 1 Ace you would then bid 6♠. And if he shows no Aces you would then . . . bid 6♠ anyway. So you leave out the middle step and bid 6♠.

Did you think about bidding 6NT instead? Ugh, they would have led a ♣.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 5

♥ K Q T 8 7 6 3

♦ 8 2

♣ T 9

♠ A J T 4

♥ J

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4 2

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♠ Q 8 7 6

♥ 5

♦ A J T 4

♣ J 8 5 3

♠ K 3 2

♥ A 9 4 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ K Q 6

West

3♥

All Pass

3♠ by South

North

Dbl

East

Pass

South

3♠

You dealt this hand.

You make a simple 3♥ opening bid and then the fireworks start. North doubles, your partner passes and South bids 3♠.

Do not preempt the same hand twice. The idea of a preemptive bid is that you bid it's maximum at your first turn. If there is to any further competing on this hand partner will have to do it.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q J 9 5

♥ Q 9 3

♦ 5 2

♣ J 6

♠ 8 6 3 2

♥ K 8

♦ A 9 6 4

♣ A 7 3



♠ T 7

♥ A J T 7 4

♦ -

♣ K Q T 9 4 2

♠ 4

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K Q J T 8 7 3

♣ 8 5

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

4 ♦

3 ♦

All Pass

4 ♦ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You do not have the 4 fast winners you need to raise partner to the 4-level. But you do have 4 of his trumps and 2 and a half winners. And your side doesn't have much defense against a 3 ♠ contract. You should raise partner to 4 ♦ because you think they can make 3 ♠. With these hands it appears they might have gone to 4 ♠ in which case you would have had to decide whether to continue to 5 ♦. More judgement would be called for, based on Vulnerability, whether you think they can make the game, etc. The Law of Total Tricks can be a help in these competitive situations; it would lead you to 5 ♦.